



▲ AZTEC MAQUAHUITL

Date 1400–1500

Origin Mexico

Length Approx. 60cm (23½in)

Material Wood, obsidian

The *maquahuitl* (broadsword) was a long war club that was used as one of an Aztec warrior's primary shock weapons. Although made of wood, it was often studded with razor-sharp flakes of obsidian or flint.



▲ AZTEC FLINT KNIFE

Date 1400–1530

Origin Mexico

Length Approx. 20cm (8in)

Material Flint

This flint knife is of an earlier type than the wood and flint *maquahuitl*. The sharp stone blade could inflict serious gashes, but was more difficult to repair than a wooden broadsword.



▲ AZTEC ATLATL

Date 1400–1500

Origin Mexico

Length 60cm (23½in)

Material Wood

The *atlatl* – a device into which a javelin or long dart was placed – was retained in the hand when the projectile was thrown, giving it around 60 per cent more force than a normal spear-throw. The darts or javelins were held in the hand and not in a quiver.

Feathers line outer edge of shield

Finger holes to grip onto atlatl when making a throw



◀ AZTEC SLING

Date 1400–1530

Origin Mexico

Length Approx. 50cm (19½in)

Material Maguety-plant fibres

Slings complemented bows as the main long-range Aztec missile weapons. Made of maguety-plant fibres, they were used to fire specially shaped spherical stones for maximum effect and had a range of up to 200m (656ft).

Pouch for slingstone

► MOCTEZUMA'S HELMET

Date 1500–1520

Origin Mexico

Material Gold, feathers

This is a reproduction of a helmet said to have belonged to Moctezuma, the last ruler of the Aztecs. It was made of gold, with 400 feathers of the sacred quetzal bird bound together with beadwork.

Feathers end in a tassel

Beadwork binding

